

```
"""
```

```
Project 1: Rule-Based AI Chatbot  
DecodeLabs AI Internship - Batch 2026
```

```
Author: Arsalan
```

```
Description:
```

```
    A rule-based conversational chatbot  
    that uses dictionary-based  
        intent matching ( $O(1)$  lookup) instead  
    of long if-elif ladders.
```

```
    The bot runs in a continuous loop,  
    sanitizes user input, matches  
        it against a knowledge base of intents,  
    and falls back to a  
        default response for unrecognized  
    input.
```

```
"""
```

```
import random  
import datetime
```

```
# -----  
-----  
# PHASE 2: KNOWLEDGE BASE  
# Dictionary of intents -> possible  
# responses.  
# Using a dictionary gives  $O(1)$  lookup  
# instead of an  $O(n)$   
# if-elif chain, and keeps the bot easy to  
# extend later.
```

```
# -----
-----
knowledge_base = {
    "hello": ["Hi there! How can I help you
today?", "Hello! Nice to see you."],
    "hi": ["Hey! What's up?", "Hi! How are
you doing?"],
    "how are you": ["I'm just a bunch of
code, but I'm running smoothly! You?",
                    "Doing great, thanks
for asking!"],
    "what is your name": ["I'm ChatBuddy,
your friendly rule-based assistant."],
    "who made you": ["I was built by
Arsalan as Project 1 for the DecodeLabs AI
Internship."],
    "what can you do": ["I can chat about a
few basic things: greetings, my name, "
                        "the time, and
jokes. Type 'help' to see options."],
    "help": ["Try saying: hello, how are
you, what is your name, tell me a joke, "
            "what time is it, or bye to
exit."],
    "tell me a joke": ["Why do programmers
prefer dark mode? Because light attracts
bugs!",
                      "Why did the AI
break up with the database? Too many
relationships."],
    "what time is it": [], # handled
dynamically below
    "thank you": ["You're welcome!",
"Anytime!"],
```

```

    "thanks": ["No problem!", "Happy to
help."],
}

# Exit commands that break the loop
exit_commands = ["bye", "exit", "quit",
"goodbye"]

def get_dynamic_response(intent):
    """Handle intents that need a computed
answer instead of a fixed string."""
    if intent == "what time is it":
        now =
datetime.datetime.now().strftime("%I:%M
%p")
        return f"Right now it's {now}."
    return None

def get_response(user_input):
    """
    Look up the cleaned user input in the
knowledge base.
    Falls back to a default 'I do not
understand' style message
    if no intent matches (using dict.get()
for a single atomic
lookup + fallback operation).
    """
    dynamic =
get_dynamic_response(user_input)
    if dynamic:
        return dynamic

```

```

        responses =
knowledge_base.get(user_input)
        if responses:
            return random.choice(responses)

        return "I'm sorry, I do not understand
that yet. Type 'help' to see what I can
do."

def chatbot():
    """Main driver: runs the continuous
input -> process -> output loop."""
    print("=" * 55)
    print(" ChatBuddy - Rule-Based AI
Chatbot (Project 1)")
    print(" Type 'help' anytime. Type 'bye'
to exit.")
    print("=" * 55)

    while True:
        raw_input_text = input("You: ")

        # PHASE 1: Sanitization /
Normalization
        clean_input =
raw_input_text.lower().strip()

        # Exit strategy: clean break out of
the infinite loop
        if clean_input in exit_commands:
            print("ChatBuddy: Goodbye! Have
a great day. 🙌")

```

```
        break

        # Skip empty input instead of
        crashing / matching wrongly
        if clean_input == "":
            print("ChatBuddy: Please type
something.")
            continue

        reply = get_response(clean_input)
        print(f"ChatBuddy: {reply}")

if __name__ == "__main__":
    chatbot()
```